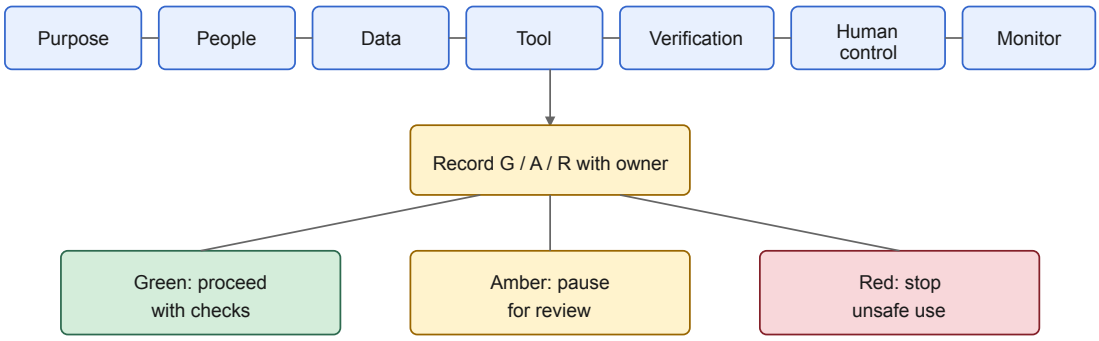
AI use decision guide

AI use decision guide

One page for quick reference. Use with your organization’s policies. Classroom use is not consultation with affected people or partners.



Seven-step AI use decision flow ending in green, amber, or red

Text equivalent: Purpose, people, data, tool, verification, human control, monitoring, then record green, amber, or red with an owner. Full table in visual aids.

Seven questions before you use AI

Step	Question	Stop if…
1. Purpose	What task does AI support? What is the manual alternative?	AI adds no value or a manual method is safer
2. People	Who is affected? Were affected people and local partners consulted?	A decision affecting communities was not consulted
3. Data	What data will you enter? Is the tool approved for that data?	Personal or sensitive data in an unapproved tool
4. Tool	Where does input go? Who can access it? Is it used for training?	Tool is unapproved or terms are unclear
5. Verification	Which claims need a trusted source? How will you check?	No way to verify consequential outputs
6. Human control	Who approves? Who can override? What is the remedy?	No named human accountable for the decision

Step	Question	Stop if…
7. Monitoring	What is the test period? What triggers a stop?	No failure threshold or incident route

Traffic-light decision

Green: proceed with checks

- Low-risk, already-approved use
- Only permitted public or internal data
- A named person will verify outputs before action
- Source checking is planned

Amber: pause for review

- Privacy, protection, or partner review needed
- Tool approval unclear
- Outputs affect access to aid, safety, or rights
- Consultation incomplete

Red: stop

- Prohibited input (personal or sensitive data in wrong tool)
- Unapproved tool for this data type
- High-stakes decision with no human review path
- No safe remedy if the output is wrong

Record your decision

Write one line: **Decision (G/A/R), owner name, next review date.**

Stop if the source is unverified or a human approval point is missing.

SAFE AI crosswalk (for training use only)

SAFE AI: *Standards and Assurance for Ethical AI*, Version 1.2, August 2026, built by CDAC Network, The Alan Turing Institute and Humanitarian AI Advisory, stewarded by CDAC Network, licensed CC BY 4.0, https://www.cdacnetwork.org/safe-ai.

SAFE AI tiers describe the **level of governance a use needs**, based on its impact. This kit's green, amber, and red describe **what a staff member should do now**. They are **not equivalent**.

SAFE AI tier	Definition (verbatim)
Tier 1 (Baseline)	"Internal, advisory AI use. Light-touch governance."
Tier 2 (Enhanced)	"AI shapes operational decisions, with human oversight. Full assessment and assurance required."
Tier 3 (High risk)	"AI directly affects people's access to assistance, protection, or information. Community co-design and

SAFE AI tier	Definition (verbatim)
	ongoing monitoring are mandatory.”

Determine the SAFE AI tier from the use’s impact. Determine green, amber or red independently using the seven questions above. A tier does not authorize proceeding. Completing an assessment, community co-design or monitoring does not remove other approval, assurance, data-protection, human-review or remedy requirements.

This crosswalk is ParalleX’s reading for training purposes; it is not part of SAFE AI, is not endorsed by its authors, and does not replace an organizational assessment.